

THE INVESTigator

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Warren Buffett – Once Again

Warren Buffett writes shareholder letters every year which are the most condensed piece of wisdom on investing ever written!

Below given are 15 important lines from his selected letters and the learning from each one.

 **"Our favourite holding period is forever." (1988)**

Learning: Long-term investing is key.

19th
Anniversary
Issue

 **"The difference between successful people and really successful people is that really successful people say no to almost everything." (2008)**

Learning: Avoid greed and focus on a few high-quality investments rather than many low-quality ones.

 **"In the business world, the rear-view mirror is always clearer than the windshield." (1999)**

Learning: Learn from past mistakes and successes.

 **"It's better to hang out with people better than you. Pick out associates whose behaviour is better than yours and you'll drift in that direction." (1998)**

Learning: Surround yourself with positive influences.

 **"The most important thing to do if you find yourself in a hole is to stop digging." (2004)**

Learning: Avoid compounding losses. Learn to cut your losses.

 **"The stock market is a device for transferring money from the impatient to the patient." (1997)**

Learning: Patience is a virtue in investing.

 **"You only have to do a very few things right in your life so long as you don't do too many things wrong." (2010)**

Learning: Focus on the important things and avoid mistakes. It is also okay if a few decisions go wrong.

 "Price is what you pay. Value is what you get." (2008)

Learning: Focus on the intrinsic value of investments.

 "Risk comes from not knowing what you're doing." (2005)

Learning: Educate yourself and understand the risks.

 "It's far better to buy a wonderful company at a fair price than a fair company at a wonderful price." (1989)

Learning: Quality is important but buying low is more important.

 "We will reject interesting opportunities rather than over-leverage our balance sheet." (2011)

Learning: Avoid taking on too much debt.

 "In the world of business, the people who are most successful are those who are doing what they love." (1998)

Learning: Investors who invest with passion are most successful.

 "Only when the tide goes out do you discover who's been swimming naked." (1992)

Learning: Hidden weaknesses are exposed during market downturns.

 "You can't make a good deal with a bad person." (2003)

Learning: Invest in companies with strong management that give priority to ethical behaviour.

 "The best thing that happens to us is when a great company gets into temporary trouble...We want to buy them when they're on the operating table." (1990)

Learning: Short-term market fluctuations and temporary corporate activities provide opportunities to purchase great companies at discounted prices.

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